

stuff.” Basically, the message is: “How much do you value your kid’s life, lady???”

There’s also judgment from society and other parents about going back to work after parental leave, even though most parents have to, and not every place of work even has paid parental leave. “It sucks,” she said in summary. I agree.

When it’s two women or two men (or two nonbinary people, depending) having a baby, there are additional costs to consider. A fan of my podcast recently wrote me an email with concerns about whether she and her wife were able to afford a baby, a dilemma I’ve been thinking a lot about.

As the fan wrote in this email: “Insurance will cover IVF for females in Hetero [sic] relationships if it is seen that they are having conceiving issues. However, they will not cover these service if it is a same sex couple cause it is not seen a medical issue. There is also the cost of finding a respectable sperm bank. Adoption is another option but costs a ridiculous amount of money. Others might have to turn to surrogacy to have kids.” These are all expenses that come into play before the fetus is even conceived.

Sale said there’s a lot of attention on (and gifts for) getting pregnant, during pregnancy, and the first year of a baby’s life, but less so on helping mothers who have children older than 1 year old. People stop helping you out, she said, but the costs keep coming and only get higher as the child ages.

THE PRICE OF *NOT* BABY MAKING

So the priority is on the birth, and not on the life of the child. Sound familiar? The cost of raising a child ties directly into the abortion debate. Having and raising a baby requires resources and money not everyone has access to. Birth control of any kind costs money too, and it’s also not 100 percent effective. In 2016, the *Atlantic* ran an article, “The Secret Shame of Middle Class Americans,” revealing that 47 percent of Americans could not come up with \$400 in the case of an emergency. An abortion can cost anywhere from \$300 to \$1,000, depending on when in the pregnancy it occurs. The DC Abortion Fund website says, “The cost of a first-trimester abortion can be more than a family on